



All-in-One Desktops

The writing's been on the wall for quite some time, however hard we try to ignore it. Desktop computing is no longer a booming business compared to the tsunami of tablets and smartphones launching every minute. More than just a cliched catchphrase, the post-PC era is a reality and we're already living in it. That's why last year, we never did test (m)any desktops, let alone any AIOs. But something sparked a second coming of sorts for the desktop PC (now sitting in the shell of an AIO), and Microsoft deserves a lot of the credit for reinvigorating this space.

With the launch of Windows 8 last fall, there was no doubt that PC manufacturers had renewed incentive in launching Windows 8 tablets and touch-enabled AIOs. This sparked a lot of innovative AIOs to come out – traditional AIOs with multitouch screens, 20-inch tablet versions with a bundled battery, hybrid AIOs with two separate processors and a detachable screen, to name a few notable trends witnessed this year. After grinding to a complete halt last year, the wheels are slowly but surely back in motion as the AIO segment regains all its lost momentum. And the steady stream of products from OEMs is a sign that all-in-one desktops are busy reinventing themselves and trying hard to reach out to a new audience. The steady stream of products slowly rolling out from OEMs, the reinventing that's happening, the fact that what we saw at shows like CES and CEBiT last year are trickling down to the masses, all these indicate that AIOs are not going to go down meekly.

Zero1 Winner

HP Pavilion 21-a255in

This machine pleasantly surprised us by comfortably edging out the rest of the competition. It's combination of a good processor paired with very good graphics running on a 7200 rpm drive supported ably by an adequate quantity of RAM proved enough. The fact that it outperforms some of its higher-priced brethren (a la the two 23-inch HP AIOs) is a strong testament to its unique quality. Not just in benchmarks, it also does a stellar job of passing our real-world tests – including stuff like watching 1080p video, better-than-average onboard speakers, and a vibrant, Full HD display. We even did some casual gaming on the thing, and you can get by on the latest games on medium settings. It doesn't stop there, as



◀ HP Pavilion 21-a255in

Price: ₹48,990

the machine is quite petite, compact and well-built; its keyboard and mouse are great to work with as well. Having three years of warranty – which is the best in this category – is another thing going for the HP Pavilion 21.

Close but no cigar:

Lenovo IdeaCentre A730

We know looks don't count for a lot in the Zero1 Awards, but the Lenovo IdeaCentre A730 is quite a stunner – an uber cool, premium, Apple iMac-esque AIO with an all-aluminium shell and sturdy design and frame. Its slim, 27-inch, multi-touch enabled screen is gorgeous in quality, and the A730's central stand has a full-90 degree tilt capability, allowing it to be used as a regular desktop and touch-enabled, flat, table-top PC. It has an enviable feature set, not to mention a Blu-ray drive and a quad-core Haswell chip complemented by the latest NVIDIA graphics. It's a machine that you absolutely must consider if you're in the market for an Apple iMac lookalike with top-of-the-line hardware, great feature set and just a unique user experience.



Lenovo IdeaCentre A730

Price: ₹1,25,990



ASUS Transformer AIO 1801

Price: ₹1,12,500

ASUS Transformer AIO 1801

The ASUS AIO Transformer is an interesting concept. It's a 3-in-1 PC that tries to cover all bases and appeal to a multitude of users, packing in an 18-inch tablet that's powered by an Nvidia Tegra 3 SoC running on Android. This does double-duty as a tablet as well as a remote display for the Transformer's base station. The second half of this machine is an AIO PC that's powered by an Intel Core i5 processor and an NVIDIA GT730M running on Windows 8. If you want a truly all-in-one device, this is the one to go for.